broken when a cow dies. (Words refer to individuals in the context of a sentence.) Proper names are treated like general terms: *Indra* stands for the class of beings possessed of the powers defining the nature of that deity.) Ritualists think that authority is restricted to statements commanding actions and telling us how to perform them. ***Vedantins*** say that fact-asserting statements in the ***Vedas*** about God, the soul and its destiny are also authoritative. The ***Nyaya*** school thinks that the *Vedic* scriptures are an instrument of knowledge because God is their reliable author. The existence of God is established not from scripture but by inference.

Buddhists deny that there is an innate relation between word and object. They also deny that words have a power to express their objects automatically. If they had, people would not need to learn languages. They dismiss the intrinsic reliability of testimony since we can never know whether another person is being honest just by listening. Since linguistic understand involves some thought process, they include it under inference.

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Bilimoria 1988; Ganeri 1999; Lipner 1986

Shaiva Siddhanta (Kashmiri): *Tantric* ritual cult teaching that the God *Shiva* (*pati*), individual souls (*pashu*) and matter are really distinct. It bases itself on a collection of twenty-eight scriptures called ***Tantras*** or *Agamas*, which are believed to be the word of God. It flourished in Kashmir from the eighth to the eleventh centuries CE. A radically modified descendent survives to this day in south India as a devotional (*bhakti*) religion. Its most important thinker was ***Ramakantha Bhatta*** (950–1000 CE). Whereas monistic schools such as the ***Trika*** emphasised intuitive knowledge (***jnana***) as the way to liberation from rebirth, the *Siddhantins* insisted on the necessity of the performance